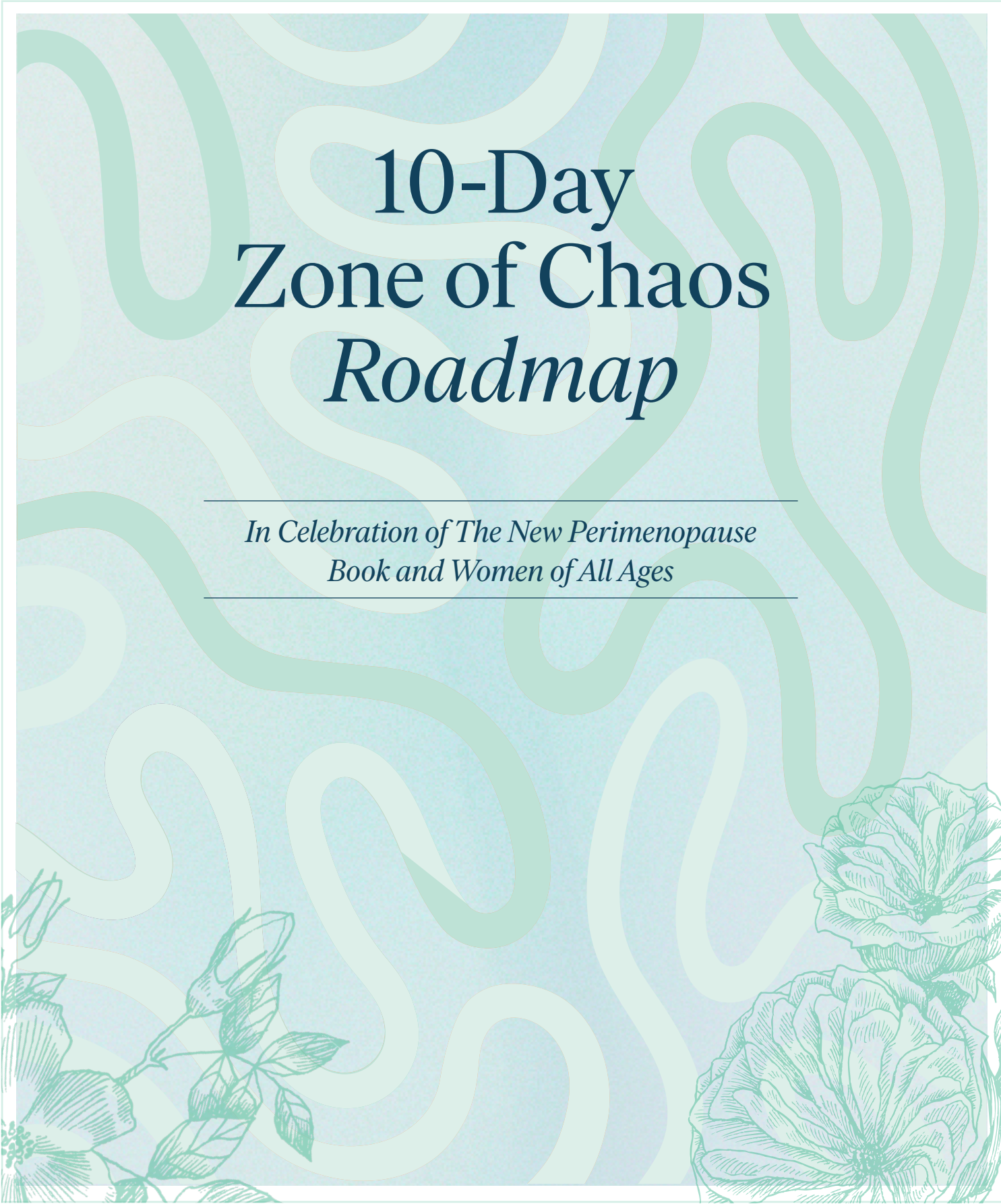




10-Day Zone of Chaos *Roadmap*

*In Celebration of The New Perimenopause
Book and Women of All Ages*

THE **PAUSE** LIFE

The menopause transition is a powerful window for shaping your long-term health.

Rather than a time of decline, it's an opportunity to take small, strategic actions that build strength, resilience, and disease prevention for the years ahead.

Over the next 10 days, we'll focus on the key foundations of health in my Perimenopause and Menopause Toolkit: nutrition, movement, sleep, and stress management. You'll learn more about the habits and tools that support these foundations, and have the opportunity to reflect on what you've learned. These insights will help you recognize patterns, build motivation, and take action.

I recommend you carve out 15–20 minutes each day to first read the lesson provided, and then use the subsequent page to check in with yourself. Jot down anything that stands out: energy, mood, sleep, cravings, curiosities, wins, or challenges. Think of this as a quick daily pause, a way to reconnect with your body and gather real-life data you can actually use.

The goal isn't perfection. It's consistency. By prioritizing nutrient-dense foods, stable blood sugar, restorative sleep, movement, and stress regulation, you can create habits. Habits that support energy, strength, and vitality now while building a foundation for healthy aging.

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Mary Claire". The signature is fluid and cursive, with a long horizontal flourish extending to the right.

Day
1*Know Your Starting Point***Understanding the Stages of Menopause**

If your body feels like it's changing faster than you can keep up, you're not alone, and you're not imagining it. Understanding the three stages of the menopause transition is the first step to feeling informed and in control.

1 Perimenopause: aka “The Zone of Chaos”

- The transitional phase before menopause, often starting in your 30s or 40s
- Can last up to 10 years
- Estrogen fluctuates unpredictably, affecting every major organ system
- 40+ symptoms are possible, and periods may become irregular, heavier, lighter, or skipped
- Diagnosed and treated by symptoms, not a single test

2 Menopause

- Officially reached after 12 consecutive months without a period (which is an arbitrary definition)
- Average age: 51 (normal range: 45–55)
- Not a phase; it's a single point in time

3 Postmenopause

- Begins the day after your menopause milestone, and lasts the rest of your life
- Hormone levels remain consistently low
- Some symptoms ease, others (like vaginal dryness or bone density loss) may persist
- Ongoing preventive care is key for managing symptoms and protecting healthspan

**Essential Resources**

[Menopause is One Day. Postmenopause Is Decades](#)
[Menopause Masterclass](#)

Day 1: Know Your Starting Point

ACTION

Take the [Menopause Quiz](#) to measure the intensity of your symptoms and receive a downloadable summary you can take to your next healthcare appointment. If you no longer have periods due to surgery, illness, or ablation, perimenopause and postmenopause can be assessed by considering your age, symptoms, and sometimes, hormone labs. A clinician can help interpret symptoms, rule out other causes and help you determine if you are in perimenopause or postmenopause.

NEXT STEPS:

- ☐ Download and print your Menopause Quiz results to share with your clinician at your next appointment.
- ☐ Commit to noting your symptoms, mood, sleep and energy levels in a journal or on the back of your results for the next 10 days.

JOURNAL:

Day
2*Understand the Foundation*

The time period from perimenopause to postmenopause can feel overwhelming, but the right tools can make all the difference. This roadmap focuses on a few simple, powerful habits that support your health during this transition:

**Nutrition**

Prioritize anti-inflammatory foods like healthy fats, lean protein, fruits, vegetables, and whole grains.

**Exercise**

Strength training and aerobic movement help protect muscle, bone, cardiovascular health and energy levels.

**Less Stress**

Mindfulness, breathing, and therapy techniques can help regulate stress and cortisol.

**Sleep**

Aim for 7–8 hours and create a calming bedtime routine. Rest truly is medicine.

**Bonus: Community**

Support, encouragement, and shared experiences make the journey easier.

Essential Resources

[The Ultimate Menopause Toolkit: A Comprehensive Approach To Managing Menopause](#)
[Pause Strong Online Program \(use coupon code STRONG20 to save!\)](#)

Day 2: Understand the Foundation

ACTION

Your goals for today:

Pick one of these tools and start building a small habit this week. Progress happens one step at a time, and you deserve to feel strong, vibrant, and supported throughout your journey.

NEXT STEPS:

- ☐ **Nutrition:** Set a goal to build each meal around a quality protein source this week.
- ☐ **Exercise:** Start where you are, even ten minutes of movement counts, and gradually build toward a routine that includes both strength and cardio each week.
- ☐ **Less Stress:** Create one small daily ritual that signals to your body that it is time to slow down, like a short meditation or stepping outside for fresh air.

JOURNAL:

Day
3*Build an Anti-Inflammatory Plate***Eat to Fight Inflammation**

What you eat can either fuel inflammation or fight it. An anti-inflammatory approach to nutrition means getting back to basics. A diet grounded in real, whole foods packed with vitamins, minerals, and antioxidants protects your cells and supports your overall health.

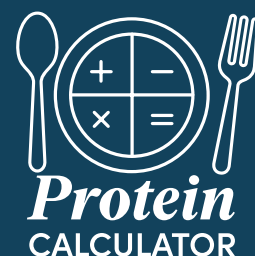
Research shows this approach may help prevent certain cancers, reduce cholesterol, and strengthen immune function. Here's where to start:

Remove or Limit

- Preservatives and artificial chemicals
- Processed carbohydrates
- Highly engineered, packaged "food-like" substances

Load Up On

- Colorful fruits and vegetables
- Lean proteins, including chicken, turkey, fish, eggs, and legumes help repair tissue and keep inflammation in check (use the [Protein Calculator](#) to determine your specific needs and [supplement](#) if needed*)
- [Fiber](#), found in vegetables, fruits, beans, and whole grains, fiber feeds healthy gut bacteria and supports a balanced inflammatory response*
- Healthy fats including olive oil and avocados
- A variety of nuts, legumes, and spices
- Omega-3 rich foods like salmon and mackerel (or supplement with an [Omega 3 supplement](#))



CLICK HERE TO
FIND YOUR TARGET

Essential Resources

[How Does Nutrition Affect Menopause](#)
[10 Tips to Limit Chronic Inflammation](#)

Day 3: Build an Anti-Inflammatory Plate

ACTION

A Simple Shopping Tip

Stick to the perimeter of the grocery store where the fresh, single-ingredient foods live. When you do venture into the center aisles, check the label: if you wouldn't find it in your own kitchen, put it back.

NEXT STEPS:

- ☐ Order [The New Perimenopause](#) and/or [The New Menopause](#)
- ☐ Read this blog post: [How Does Nutrition Affect Menopause](#)
- ☐ Take the [Nutrition Inflammation Quiz](#) and make note of your score.
Retake it anytime to track your progress!

JOURNAL: _____

Day
4*Move for Strength & Well-Being*

Many women start noticing joint pain, stiffness, or decreased strength during the transition from perimenopause to postmenopause and assume it's just aging. But hormonal changes, especially fluctuating estrogen, can affect bone density, muscle strength, and joint stability earlier than many people realize. Movement is one of the most powerful tools to help protect your bones during this stage of life.

How to move to support bone health in perimenopause:

- **Lift weights regularly.** Resistance training at least 2 times per week helps stimulate bone growth and maintain muscle that supports and protects your joints.
- **Add impact movement.** Activities like brisk walking, jogging, stair climbing, jumping, or dancing help strengthen bones through mechanical loading. These activities can also get your heart pumping! Win win!
- **Train for strength, not just cardio.** Muscles pulling on bones help maintain bone density and stability.
- **Stay consistent.** Bone and muscle respond to regular challenge over time, not occasional workouts.
- **Prioritize balance and stability.** Strengthening the core and stabilizing muscles helps reduce fall and fracture risk.
- **Keep your body moving throughout the day.** Take the stairs, stretch at your desk, walk during calls, because every bit of activity adds up, even beyond your daily workout.

Essential Resources

[Menopause and Muscle Loss: Why Sarcopenia Starts Sooner Than We Thought](#)
[Build Strength, Live Longer: The Menopause Longevity Blueprint with Dr. Vonda Wright](#)

The time period between perimenopause and post menopause is a critical window to build and protect bone strength. Start adding resistance training and impact movement into your routine this week – even small steps can make a powerful difference for your long-term health.

NEXT STEPS:

- [illegible]

Day
5*Sleep Like it's Medicine*

Sleep problems during perimenopause are not something you just have to endure. They're not a sign of weakness or personal failure. They're a legitimate medical issue with real consequences for your cardiovascular health, cognitive function, and quality of life.

- **Sleep supports brain health.** It helps the brain clear waste, repair itself, and strengthen memory and learning.
- **Poor sleep affects thinking and focus.** Even losing 90 minutes of sleep per night can reduce cognitive performance.
- **Sleep is critical for heart health.** Women with poor sleep during menopause are more likely to develop cardiovascular problems.
- **Sleep helps regulate the immune system.** Without enough rest, the body may stay in a state of chronic inflammation.
- **Sleep stabilizes mood.** Getting less than seven hours can increase negative emotional reactions and reduce positive ones.
- **Sleep helps control cravings.** Adequate rest makes it easier to choose healthier foods and avoid ultra-processed snacks.

As with all healthy habits, working to improve your sleep is not about perfection. It's about pausing, tuning in, and making small but powerful shifts that support your well-being, one night at a time.

- 1 **Set** a consistent sleep and wake time (even on the weekends).
- 2 **Create** a wind-down routine 30–60 minutes before bed by avoiding screens, bright lights, and stress triggers.
- 3 **Cut off** caffeine early, at least 6–8 hours before bed.
- 4 **Optimize** your sleep environment by making your bedroom cool, dark, and quiet.
- 5 **Limit** screen time before bed, turning off screens at least 30–60 minutes before sleeping.
- 6 **Spend** 10–15 minutes outside early in the day or open the curtains fully to enjoy natural light in the morning.
- 7 **Consider** [supplementation](#) to support your circadian rhythm*.
- 8 **Take** time to reflect on your sleep quality, mood, and energy levels.

Essential Resources

[Sleep, Hormones, and Health: What You Need to Know](#)

[The Sleep Crisis in Menopause: Insomnia, Sleep Apnea & Solutions](#)

Day 5: Sleep Like it's Medicine

ACTION

Download or print this [handy guidebook](#) and use it as a tool to track the quality of your sleep for the next week or two. See if you can identify if your sleep is affected positively or negatively as a result of the previous day's activity or nutrition. Share your observations in [The 'Pause Life Community](#).

NEXT STEPS:

- ☐ Check out #SleepSOS in [The 'Pause Life Community](#).
- ☐ No screens 60 min before bed
- ☐ Cool your room to 65–68°F tonight



JOURNAL:

Day
6*Support Your Gut Health*

Hormonal changes during perimenopause don't just affect sleep and mood, they can also impact your gut microbiome. As estrogen fluctuates and declines, the balance of bacteria in the gut can shift, influencing metabolism, immune health, mood, and weight regulation. The good news is that your daily habits, especially what you eat, can help support a healthier gut.

Ways to support your gut microbiome:

- **Eat a wide variety of plant foods.** Fruits, vegetables, whole grains, legumes, nuts, and seeds provide **fiber** and nutrients that help beneficial gut bacteria thrive.
- **Eat the rainbow.** Different colored plants contain polyphenols—compounds with antioxidant and anti-inflammatory properties that support gut and overall health.
- **Prioritize plant diversity.** Different plants contain different prebiotics that feed different bacteria, helping maintain a diverse and resilient microbiome.
- **Add probiotic foods.** Yogurt, kefir, sauerkraut, kimchi, miso, and fermented pickles help replenish beneficial bacteria.
- **Include prebiotic foods.** Onions, kiwi, pomegranate, flaxseed, and bananas help feed the healthy bacteria already in your gut.
- **Consider extra support if needed.** Synbiotic supplements combine probiotics with the fibers they need to grow.

Research also shows that higher fruit and vegetable intake is associated with lower mortality, highlighting just how powerful plant-rich eating can be for long-term health.

Essential Resources

[30 Plants a Week: Why Gut Health Matters More After 40](#)

[3 Ways Menopause Changes the Gut Microbiome](#)

Day 6: Support Your Gut Health

ACTION

Aim to add more colorful plants, and prebiotic and probiotic foods to your plate each day. The more variety you eat, the more you support a healthy, diverse gut microbiome and your overall well-being in midlife. Use our plant tracker on page 19 to help you keep track of your progress.

NEXT STEPS:

- ☐ Eat 5+ diverse plant foods
- ☐ Include a fermented or probiotic food



JOURNAL:

Day
7*Stress Is Real, Tackle It*

If you've felt more anxious, irritable, or emotionally off during perimenopause, you're not imagining it. Hormonal changes affect brain chemistry, including areas that regulate mood and stress. These shifts are real, and they deserve attention and support.

Why mood changes happen in midlife:

- **Hormone fluctuations affect the brain.** Changes in estrogen influence brain receptors and the amygdala (your mood center).
- **Stress hormones increase.** Elevated cortisol can worsen metabolic health, weaken immunity, and increase risks like insulin resistance.
- **Stress management becomes essential.** What worked in your 20s may not be enough during this transition.

Simple ways to support your mood and stress levels:

- Deep breathing or meditation
- Yoga, Tai Chi, or gentle stretching
- Walking (alone or with a friend)
- Listening to calming music
- Journaling or tracking symptoms
- Practicing good sleep hygiene

Essential Resources

[Meditation: Choosing What Supports Me](#)

[Mood Swings, Rage and "Not Feeling Like Myself"](#)

Day 7: Stress is Real, Tackle It

ACTION

Start with one small daily practice. Even just five minutes of breathing, journaling, or a short walk can help regulate stress, support mood, and build resilience during the menopause transition.

NEXT STEPS:

- ☐ Try box breathing (inhaling, holding, exhaling, and holding again for a slow count of four repeated four times.)
- ☐ Walk in nature
- ☐ Visit #Meditation & Journaling in [The 'Pause Life Community](#).

JOURNAL:

Day
8*Strong Over Skinny*

Rethink the definition of health. The menopause transition brings hormonal changes that affect muscle, bone, metabolism, and body composition. Instead of chasing thinness, shifting your focus to strength, nutrition, and health is the key to aging well and feeling your best. The choices you make today impact how strong, mobile, and resilient you will be in the years to come.

How to prioritize strength over thinness:

- **Flip your mindset.** Focus on adding healthy habits instead of restricting or cutting foods.
- **Fuel your body properly.** Adequate protein and balanced nutrition support muscle and bone health.
- **Lift weights and move.** Resistance training preserves muscle, bone density, and metabolic function.
- **Stay active for your heart.** Cardiovascular movement strengthens your heart, improves circulation, and boosts overall well-being. For an extra challenge, add a [weighted vest](#) to activities like walks, errands and chores.
- **Track goals and habits.** Journaling helps you stay committed, see progress, and reinforce positive changes.

Essential Resources

[Healthspan: How to Thrive Through Menopause with Strength, Nutrition, and Purpose](#)
[Aging Strong: Preventing Frailty, Osteoporosis and Muscle Loss](#)

Day 8: Strong Over Skinny

ACTION

Stop chasing a smaller body and start building a stronger, healthier you. Schedule a workout today, go for a walk, pick up weights. Need more suggestions? Go to the #Fitness Rec space in the [The 'Pause Life Community](#).

Make daily choices that protect your muscles, bones, and metabolism and your future self will thank you.

Strength today = vitality tomorrow.

NEXT STEPS:

- ☐ Use the [Protein Calculator](#) and learn your target
- ☐ Pick a workout from the #Fitness Recs section
- ☐ Share your movement on social

JOURNAL: _____

Day
9*Connection isn't Extra, it's Essential*

Perimenopause and postmenopause can bring about some big changes physically, emotionally, and socially. Feeling uncertain or isolated is common, but connecting with a supportive community can transform this stage of life into one of confidence, empowerment, and growth.

Why community matters:

- **Emotional support.** Reduces isolation, normalizes experiences, and provides a safe space to share challenges and victories.
- **Knowledge and resources.** Access practical strategies, evidence-based information, and diverse perspectives on health and wellness.
- **Empowerment.** Encourages self-advocacy and informed decision-making about your care and lifestyle.
- **Connection and friendships.** Build meaningful relationships that extend beyond symptom support, in person or online.
- **Inspiration and motivation.** Seeing others navigate midlife successfully can boost confidence and resilience.

Essential Resources

[What Predicts the Longest Lifespan in Women?](#)

[Why Midlife Is a Woman's Most Powerful and Transformational Decade](#)

Day 9: Connection isn't Extra, it's Essential

ACTION

Say yes to connection! Perimenopause, menopause, and postmenopause are transformative stages full of change, challenges, and opportunities for growth. Being part of a supportive community, whether in person or online, offers the connection and understanding that makes navigating this transition easier.

Sharing what you are experiencing with those around you, whether friends, family, or others going through the same thing, can reduce isolation, foster deeper understanding, and help you work through challenges.

NEXT STEPS:

- ☐ Share the [Man's Guide to Menopause](#) with the men in your life so they have the tools to show up for you and build a deeper, more meaningful connection.
- ☐ Head to [The 'Pause Life Community](#) and introduce yourself in #Say Hello

JOURNAL: _____

Day
10*Finish Strong & Look Forward***Congratulations on completing the 10-Day Zone of Chaos Roadmap!**

Your future health is being built right now. Not just how long you live, but how well you live. Your strength, metabolic health, bone density, cognitive clarity, energy, and joy do not happen by accident. They are the cumulative result of daily choices. How you move, how you fuel your body, how you sleep, manage stress, and advocate for your own care all matter.

Here are some key reminders to keep in mind as you continue in your perimenopause journey:

- **Strength training** is essential.
- **Protein** supports muscle and metabolic health.
- **Fiber** supports your hormones and gut health during perimenopause.
- **Sleep** is medicine.
- **Stress** impacts your body, not just your mind.
- **Mindset and boundaries matter** as much as lifestyle habits.
- **Advocate** for your health! Don't minimize symptoms.

The menopause transition is not the beginning of decline, it's the beginning of a powerful opportunity to take ownership of your future health. **If you are postmenopausal, it is not too late for you to make changes that support your body, mind and soul now and for years to come. And, now that you've completed The Zone of Chaos Roadmap it's time to take your momentum forward!**

The habits you build now can shape how strong, energized, and resilient you feel for decades to come. Choose one key habit from this list to focus on this week, whether it's eating more protein, adding strength training, prioritizing sleep, boosting fiber, or managing stress. Small, consistent actions today create a stronger, healthier, and more empowered you for the years ahead.

Congratulations on completing your 10-Day Zone of Chaos Roadmap! My latest book, *[The New Perimenopause](#)* offers the science, strategies, and practical tools to help you navigate this transition with confidence. Join the [#TNPBOOKCLUB](#) and share this challenge with a friend or family member. The more you know, the more you know!

Invest in yourself now! Your future self will thank you.

- ☐ Commit to one habit you'll keep going
- ☐ Start reading [*The New Perimenopause*](#) and/or [*The New Menopause*](#)
- ☐ Go deeper with [**The Pause Strong Program**](#): it's your roadmap for the next phase of life with lifetime access, digital and audio experiences, and monthly support calls.
- ☐ Join our [**Free Community**](#)

[illegible]

Daily Plant Tracker

WEEK 1

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WEEK 4

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This list is meant to spark ideas, not set limits. If it grows from the ground, count it—and add any plant foods you enjoy as you work through the challenge.

Fruits

Apples
Avocados
Bananas
Blueberries
Strawberries
Raspberries
Blackberries
Dates
Figs
Limes Grapefruit
Olives
Oranges Lemons
Pomegranates
Tomatoes

Vegetables & Greens

Artichokes
Arugula
Beets
Bell peppers
Bok choy
Broccoli
Cabbage
Carrots
Cauliflower
Eggplant
Fennel
Garlic

Kale

Leeks
Lettuce
Onions
Spinach
Sweet potatoes
Zucchini

Beans & Legumes

Black beans
Cannellini beans
Chickpeas
Edamame
Kidney beans
Lentils

Pinto beans

Split peas
Grains & Pseudograins
Barley
Brown rice
Buckwheat
Farro
Millet
Oats
Quinoa
Wild rice

Nuts & Seeds

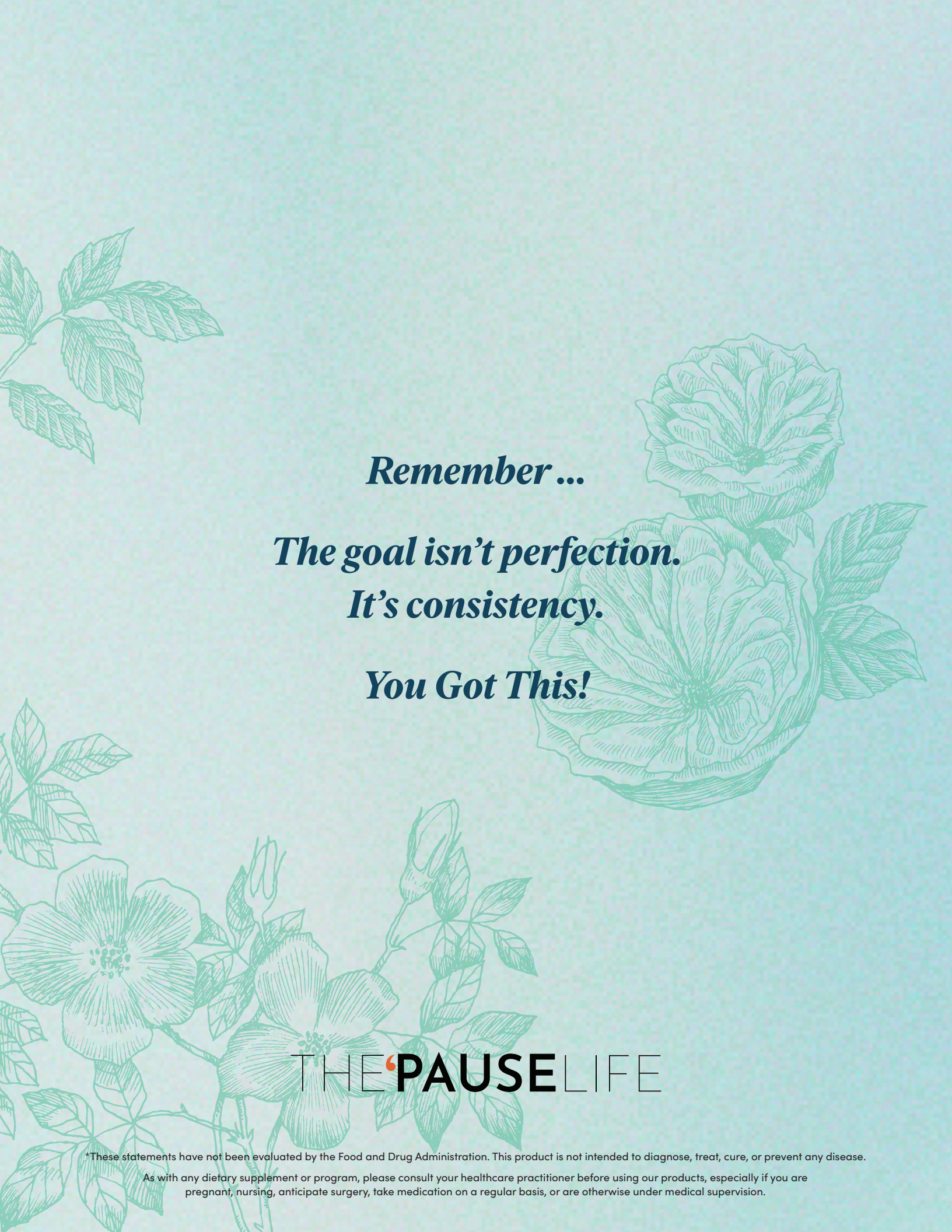
Almonds
Cashews
Chia seeds
Flax seeds
Hemp seeds
Pecans
Pistachios
Pumpkin seeds
Sesame seeds
Sunflower seeds
Walnuts

Herbs & Spices

Basil
Black pepper
Cilantro
Cinnamon
Dill
Ginger
Mint
Oregano
Paprika
Parsley
Rosemary
Thyme
Turmeric

Extras That Count

Avocado oil
Cocoa / dark chocolate
Coffee
Mushrooms
Olive oil
Tea (green, black, herbal)
Vinegar (balsamic, apple cider, red wine)



Remember ...

***The goal isn't perfection.
It's consistency.***

You Got This!

THE **PAUSE** LIFE

*These statements have not been evaluated by the Food and Drug Administration. This product is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any disease.

As with any dietary supplement or program, please consult your healthcare practitioner before using our products, especially if you are pregnant, nursing, anticipate surgery, take medication on a regular basis, or are otherwise under medical supervision.